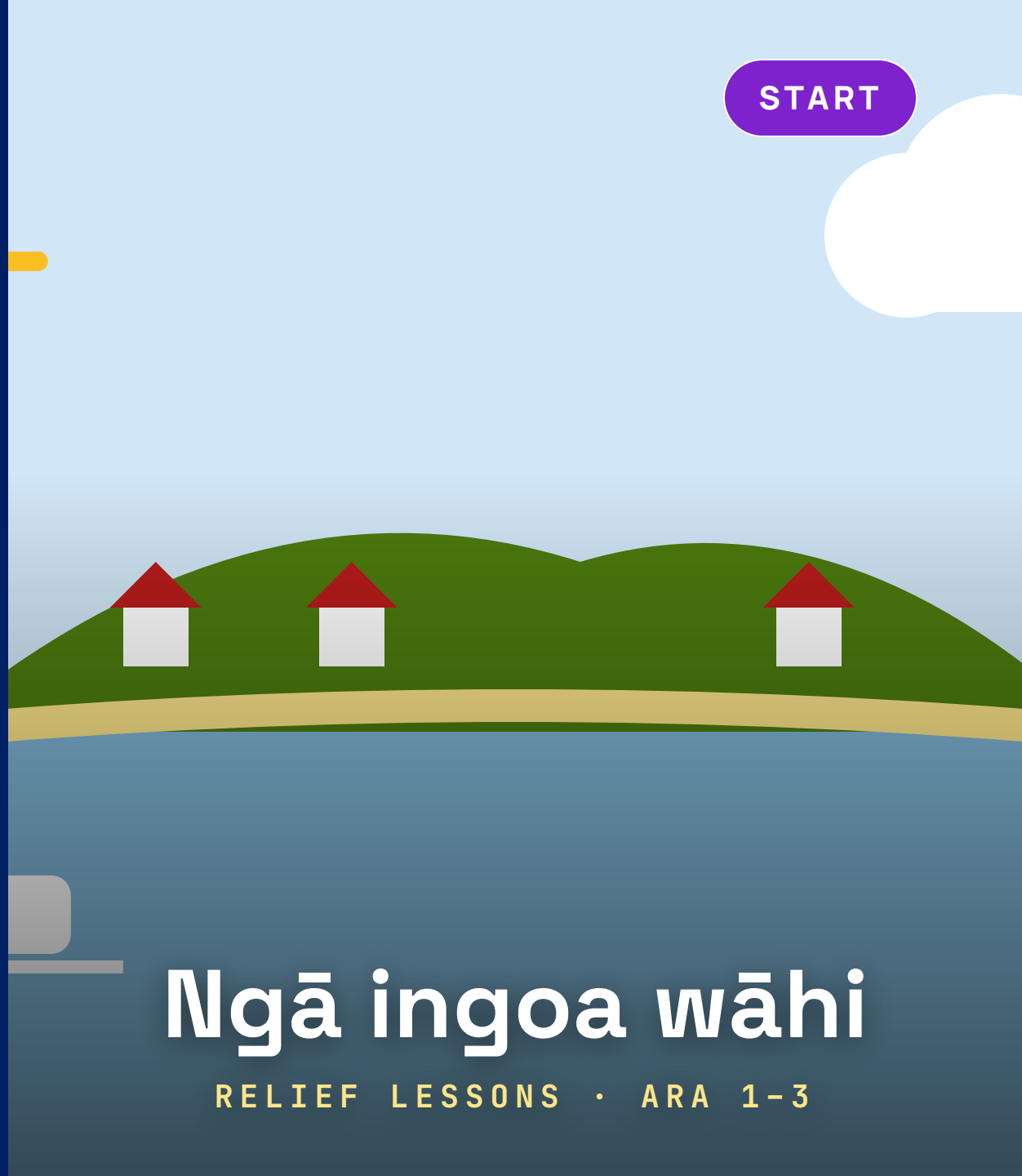
2

LESSON 2 · ANY LEVEL

Place-name detectives

Te Reo Māori · Relief lessons

WHS



START

WHAT WE ARE LEARNING

We are learning to break Māori place names into parts to work out what they mean.

SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can recognise common parts of place names (wai, roto, maunga, motu, nui, iti).
- I can work out the meaning of some place names.
- I can create and explain a place name (Ara 3).

LEARN

What does “Rotorua” mean?

- roto = lake
- rua = two
- Rotorua = the second lake

LEARN

Word parts · ngā wāhanga kupu

wai water	**roto** lake	**maunga** mountain	**motu** island
awa river	**nui** big	**iti** small	**roa** long
tapu sacred	**wera** hot	**one** sand; beach	**puke** hill

LEARN

Let’s decode

Name	Parts	Meaning
Waiwera	wai + wera	hot water
Rotoiti	roto + iti	small lake
Oneroa	one + roa	long beach
Aotearoa	ao + tea + roa	long white cloud

DO

Your task

Worksheet Everyone: Part A, decode the names.

Worksheet Then your Ara section.

Device Finished? Explore the Place Names Map (if devices are allowed).

FINISH

↻ REVIEW

Kōrero

- Which name did you like most? What does it mean?
- Ara 3: share your invented place name.